

**FLAT
AGAINST
THE GROUND**

Many alpine plants spread over the ground in the form of flat mats, keeping out of the path of icy winds. *Mazus reptans* is a mat-forming plant from the Himalayas.

Mazus reptans

Garland flower

A MINIATURE SHRUB

This alpine daphne, or garland flower, is a shrub in miniature. Larger daphnes grow at lower levels.

Alpine moltkias

SMALL LEAVES

Moltkias are members of the forget-me-not family. Unlike many of their lowland relatives, alpine moltkias have small leaves, which are better able to withstand strong mountain winds.

MOUNDS OF COLOR

Like many alpine plants, this beautiful phlox from North America has brilliantly colored flowers. They stand out against the rocky slopes and attract pollinating insects.

Alpine phlox

DUAL PROTECTION

Mountain rock roses are protected from the weather in two ways. The bushy plants are able to stand up to strong winds better than those with taller, more rigid stems. Their leaves and stems are covered with fine hairs that act as insulation at night.

Rock rose

TWO WAYS TO SPREAD

This species of storksbill lives in the high Pyrenees of Europe. It spreads both with seeds and with its creeping root system (p. 32).

Storksbill

MOUNTAIN DWARF

Many mountain plants that survive at great heights, such as this St. John's wort, are much smaller than their lowland relatives.

St. John's wort